Change UUID of Partition in Linux Filesystem

How to Change UUID of Partition in Linux Filesystem

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for BTRFS:

btrfstune -M <new-uuid> <device>

In this short tutorial, you are going to learn how to change the **UUID** of a Linux partition. This can help you in a less likely to happen scenario when the **UUID** of two partitions are the same.

In reality, this is really hard to happen, but it is still possible, if for example you copy a partition using dd command.

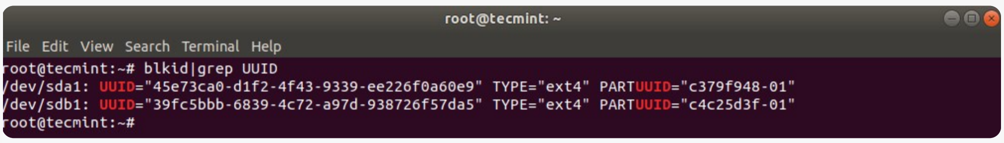
What is UUID?

UUID stands for **Universally Unique IDentifier** of a partition. This **ID** is used in few different places to identify the partition. Most commonly this would be **/etc/fstab**.

How to Find UUID of Your Filesystems

To find the **UUID** of your partitions, you can use blkid command as shown.

```
# blkid|grep UUID
```



```
root@tecmint: ~
File  Edit  View  Search  Terminal  Help
root@tecmint:~# blkid|grep UUID
/dev/sda1: UUID="45e73ca0-d1f2-4f43-9339-ee226f0a60e9" TYPE="ext4" PARTUUID="c379f948-01"
/dev/sdb1: UUID="39fc5bbb-6839-4c72-a97d-938726f57da5" TYPE="ext4" PARTUUID="c4c25d3f-01"
root@tecmint:~#
```

Find Partition UUID in Linux

How to Change UUID of Your Filesystems

Changing **UUID** of a filesystem is fairly easy. To do this, we are going to use **tune2fs**. For the purpose of this tutorial, I will change the **UUID** on my second partition `/dev/sdb1`, yours may vary, thus make sure you are changing the UUID of the desired filesystem.

The partition has to be unmounted prior apply the new **UUID**:

```
# umount /dev/sdb1
# tune2fs -U random /dev/sdb1
# blkid | grep sdb1
```

```
root@tecmint: ~
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
root@tecmint:~# blkid |grep sdb1
/dev/sdb1: UUID="0b30513a-909d-4622-bd16-10f6ba7639ea" TYPE="ext4" PARTUUID="c4c25d3f-01"
root@tecmint:~# tune2fs -U random /dev/sdb1
tune2fs 1.44.1 (24-Mar-2018)
Setting UUID on a checksummed filesystem could take some time.
Proceed anyway (or wait 5 seconds to proceed) ? (y,N) y
root@tecmint:~# blkid |grep sdb1
/dev/sdb1: UUID="15030ae8-7f17-4ae7-b905-d5e3014b9be8" TYPE="ext4" PARTUUID="c4c25d3f-01"
root@tecmint:~#
```

Change Partition UUID in Linux

The **UUID** has been successfully changed. Now you can mount the filesystem back again.

```
# mount /dev/sdb1
```

You can also update your **/etc/fstab** if needed, with the new **UUID**.

For { BTRFS } filesystems

Change uuid of btrfs partition

btrfstune can be used to enable, disable, or set various filesystem parameters. The filesystem must be unmounted.

The common usecase is to enable features that were not enabled at mkfs time. Please make sure that you have kernel support for the features. You can find a complete list of features and kernel version of their introduction at https://btrfs.wiki.kernel.org/index.php/Changelog#By_feature . Also, the manual page mkfs.btrfs(8) contains more details about the features.

Some of the features could be also enabled on a mounted filesystem by other means. Please refer to the *FILESYSTEM FEATURES* in btrfs(5).

btrfstune -M <new-uuid> <device>